



State of the City: Dan Ridenour 2023

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=I92001HxBI8
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Municipal Meeting Summary Report: Muncie State of the City Address

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The provided transcript does not contain a statutory public hearing or committee session held prior to the meeting.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The event is introduced by Judd of "Next Muncie" [00:00:01](#) before turning the floor over to Mayor Dan Ridenour to deliver the annual State of the City report for Muncie, Indiana [[00:00:04](#), [00:02:26](#)].
- **Attendance:** Presiding officer is Mayor Dan Ridenour. Several city officials, department heads, and community members are explicitly recognized in attendance, including:
 - Controller Craig Wright and Deputy Controller Matt Wagley [00:10:45](#)
 - Police Chief and Deputy Police Chief [00:25:26](#)
 - Fire Chief and Deputy Fire Chief [00:25:28](#)
 - Animal Shelter Director Katie Wolfe [00:31:48](#)
 - Troy (Beech Grove Cemetery) [00:30:41](#)
 - Carl Malone (Parks Department) [00:36:43](#)

- Adam and Donnie (Public Works / Street Department) [00:41:52](#)
- HR Director Micah [00:52:57](#)
- Gretchen (Community Development) [00:53:17](#)
- Building Commissioner Bob Jesse, Steve Selvey, and staff [00:53:21](#)
- Michelle (Communications) [00:54:06](#)

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening remarks included expressions of gratitude to God and the mayor's wife, Sherry [00:01:31](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** *Not applicable to this address format.*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

The meeting format consisted of the annual mayoral address and programmatic update rather than traditional legislative roll call items, ordinances, or resolutions requiring board votes.

- [00:02:33](#) **State of the City Address & Administration Progress Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mayor Dan Ridenour
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The mayor delivered a comprehensive review contrasting the city's financial, public safety, and infrastructural standing on January 1, 2020, against achievements as of December 31, 2022:
 - **Financial Turnaround:** Addressed initial deficits of 18 negative accounts totaling \$3.3 million (including a \$250,000 overdraft in the mayor's EDIT funds and a \$1.9 million overdraft in roads/streets). Bond rating was previously at Triple B minus. Muncie Redevelopment Commission (MRC) debt was reduced by \$5.56 million (from \$58.39M down to \$52.83M). Total cash reserves across city funds grew from \$19.36M (2019) to \$22.05M (2022).
 - **Housing & Development:** Highlighted 270 new housing units either completed, under construction, or planned across 10 neighborhoods (aligning with the "Together DM" core stabilization plan). Noted an increase in building permits from 21 in 2019 to 177 in 2022.
 - **EDIT Funds Realignment:** Shifted spending priorities away from heavy legal fees toward environmental cleanup, parks, housing, and non-profit support.
 - **Public Safety & Crisis Support:** Increased police and fire pay by 9-10% in 2020. Outlined progress on a new 24-hour Crisis Center developed over 20 months in collaboration with IU Health and local nonprofits. Highlighted Muncie Police Department stats (46,171 calls in 2022 with only 211 responses involving physical resistance). Announced plans for two new state-of-the-art fire stations (Stations 5 and 6).

- **Parks & Recreation:** Detailed upgrades to Prairie Creek Reservoir (noted as the #1 participant experience for Ironman 70.3 in North America), the addition of sand, floating docks, splash pads (four total planned), Lafferty field upgrades (\$1.5M), and the Ziegler Foundation memory spiral at Heekin Park.
 - **Infrastructure & Paving:** Addressed road condition ratings (improving from an initial baseline index score of 52.8 to 61). Installed 226 ADA-accessible curbs, paved 68 roads in 2022, reinstated a municipal concrete crew, and acquired municipal paving/milling equipment.
 - **Remote Worker Program:** Recruited 30 out-of-state remote workers through 2022, bringing average household incomes of \$91,874 and driving local economic impact.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational address; no formal board action or vote required.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

The transcript contains no open public comment period or floor questions from citizens; the agenda was dedicated entirely to the mayoral address.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Mayor Ridenour noted ongoing union contract negotiations for 2023 and anticipated continued revenue growth.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded following the mayor's closing remarks celebrating Muncie's strong momentum [00:54:46](#). (Exact adjournment timestamp not explicitly stated in transcript text).
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